50TH ANNIVERSARY

PHOTO FEATURE

ON THE EDGE OF HISTORY

History is often told through momentous events, periods of social upheaval, and the faces of the powerful. But life is a continuum, ever flowing between public and private, power and vulnerability, ceremony and chaos. History inhabits these liminal spaces as well.

INDIA TODAY has documented not only the decisive moments of the past five decades, but also the images that exist on the margins of these events. In these pictures, history's protagonists appear unguarded, caught in gestures that humanise or haunt, in contexts that complicate our understanding of their place in time.

Through the lens of INDIA TODAY's finest photographers, we encounter the unofficial, the tender and the troubling—moments that resist easy categorisation. The marginal here is an alternative archive, of history that resides in streets, homes, borders and in the silences of common people. These images may lie outside official memory, yet are no less a depiction of the texture of an era.